

well. As a political scientist, Simon was deeply involved in the understanding of how large decision-making systems worked. In his research, he had realised that making a decision wasn't a mathematical process. Mathematicians took the human brain's decision-making ability and confused rationality with optimisation. The "right" decision was always the outcome that would be most fruitful given a situation's parameters. Simon, however, proposed that rationality wasn't always about getting the optimal output. Instead, he said that it involved a wide variety of factors, including the limitations of a person's mind, the amount of time they have to make a decision and the information they have at that point. He contended that it was impossible to have perfect and complete information at any given time to make a decision – a perspective that would eventually win him a Nobel Prize. Simon would go on to encapsulate all of this into a theory called "Bounded Rationality", but going into that would make us digress too much from our core matter here.

What concerns here is Simon's view that decision-making need not always be about coming up with the most optimal solution each time. It was this leniency afforded by Simon to the human thought process that allowed him to see the printer in a way that no one around him did.

In Allan Newell, he met a kindred spirit. Newell was a computer scientist at RAND who had developed the program to print the map.



John McCarthy set the ball rolling with a simple question